Study Habits and Self-Reported Academic Performance

Among senior high school students | Fictional research proposal

DEMO ONLY: This draft is intentionally incomplete so reviewers can practice identifying gaps. It describes a proposed study. No survey has been conducted, no school is identified, and no findings or academic sources are fabricated.

1. Background and research problem

Students organize their study time in different ways. Some review lessons every day, while others concentrate their preparation close to an examination. This proposed study asks whether reported study habits are associated with self-reported academic performance among senior high school students. The project aims to help a student research team describe patterns that could inform study-planning discussions. The proposal does not assume that one habit causes higher grades.

2. General and specific objectives

The general objective is to examine the relationship between selected study habits and self-reported academic performance. The specific objectives are: (1) describe the frequency and duration of students' study sessions; (2) describe how often students use planned study schedules; and (3) examine whether these measures are associated with self-reported average grades from the most recent completed grading period.

3. Research questions and measures

Question 1: How many days per week do participating students study outside scheduled classes? Question 2: How often do they follow a study schedule? Question 3: What association exists between reported study time, schedule use, and self-reported average grade? Study time will be recorded as days per week and approximate minutes per study day. Schedule use will be recorded on a five-point frequency scale. Academic performance will be measured using the student's self-reported average grade for the most recent completed grading period.

4. Significance and scope

The intended population is senior high school students. The proposal focuses on study routines and reported grades rather than intelligence, teaching quality, or access to learning resources. The research team intends to produce a descriptive classroom report. Any association would support further investigation rather than justify an official judgment about a student.

Proposed methods

5. Research design and participants

The study will use a quantitative, cross-sectional correlational design. The team intends to collect approximately 60 questionnaire responses from senior high school students through a shared survey link. Students will answer once during a single collection period. The team has not yet specified a sampling method, eligibility rules, or recruitment process. These decisions will be completed before any data collection begins.

6. Questionnaire and collection procedure

A short questionnaire will record study frequency, approximate study duration, schedule use, and the self-reported average grade. The survey will be distributed through a link and remain open for one week. Example item 1: During a typical week, on how many days do you study outside scheduled classes? Example item 2: About how many minutes do you study on those days? The team will export responses to a spreadsheet and check for duplicate or incomplete entries. The questionnaire has not yet undergone a clarity check.

7. Proposed analysis

The team will summarize study frequency and duration with descriptive statistics. Schedule-use responses will be reported as category counts. After checking the data and the assumptions of the selected method, the team will examine associations between study measures and reported average grades. The specific correlation procedure and treatment of missing responses have not yet been selected. The report will state that a correlation does not establish causation.

8. Data handling note

The exported spreadsheet will be stored on the team's shared drive while the report is prepared. A complete ethics and data protection procedure has not yet been written. No collection should begin until appropriate consent and safeguards are established.

9. Limitations and references

Self-reported grades may contain recall errors. Students who choose to complete the questionnaire may differ from students who do not respond. A one-time survey cannot establish which factor occurred first. The literature review and reference list are not yet included; the team must locate, read, and cite real academic sources before submission.